Visual Effects was tasked with rendering ninety percent of the backdrop for the surveillance hub, which existed on three levels as three different sets housed on three different stages.

"If the actors were on the top level of the set, we would create the middle and bottom level in CG," DeLeeuw explains. "Depending on where the action took place, we would create the level above or below the actors. The bottom dome is nestled under the belly of the Helicarrier, and that created the biggest challenge.

"We created a raised set with lights that could shine up through plexiglass. We needed green screen to matte the characters, so the Grip Department created green baffles around the lights. When viewed from an angle, the baffles hid the lights and created a continuous green screen.

"The dome itself is transparent, which required us to see Washington, D.C., in the distance. Rather than trying to create all of D.C. on the computer, we shot still and moving footage from a helicopter that was tiled together to create a 360-degree cyclorama. This background was then composited behind our actors to give the illusion that they are fighting thousands of feet above the Potomac."